Measuring Antisemitism Carefully

Four methods papers on what is recorded, how it spreads, what people believe, and what algorithms show.

Decisions about antisemitism, such as where to send security resources, how to judge a policy or what to ask of a platform, rest on numbers. Each of our first four papers takes one kind of number, shows how it can mislead, builds methods to measure it more honestly, and tests those methods on computer-simulated data where the right answer is known. **None reports real-world findings yet;** each ends with a plan for how the real measurement would be done.

THE FOUR PAPERS

PAPER 1

The Dark Figure

How many antisemitic incidents go unrecorded?

By checking which antisemitic incidents turn up on more than one incomplete list, we can estimate how many incidents every list missed, and say honestly how unsure that estimate is.

Read the one-page brief →

PAPER 2

Shock and Contagion

After a major event, how much of a surge is reaction, and how much is contagion?

When antisemitic incidents spike after a major event, our tools estimate how much of the spike is a direct reaction and how much is incidents setting off more incidents, and say clearly when the data cannot tell the two apart.

Read the one-page brief →

PAPER 3

Where Does Criticism End?

How closely do views about Israel travel with stereotypes about Jews?

We built a survey method that checks, one statement at a time and with rules fixed in advance, how closely agreeing with a statement about Israel goes together with agreeing with classic stereotypes about Jews, without taking a side in the debate over where criticism ends.

Read the one-page brief →

PAPER 4

Supply or Demand?

Do recommendation algorithms supply antisemitic content beyond what users seek?

We define precisely what it would mean for a recommendation algorithm to push antisemitic posts to people beyond what they go looking for, and design a careful, ethical way to test whether one does.

Read the one-page brief →

WHAT THESE PAPERS ARE NOT

STATUS **Methods papers, with no real-world findings.** No actual incident counts, contagion, attitudes or platform behaviour have been measured yet. Each paper proposes how to measure these things responsibly and sets out a plan, with its analysis code, to be registered publicly before any real data are examined.

HOW THIS WORK WAS MADE

These papers were drafted with substantial AI assistance (Anthropic's Claude). The lab chose the questions, directed the research and reviewed the results. The drafts then went through independent automated review passes (referee-style critiques, fact-checks of cited sources and, for the first two papers, independent audits of the simulation code) and were revised in response. Every simulation result in the papers is produced by the released code, from computer-simulated data. They are methods papers, not findings: they have not been peer-reviewed or published, and none of the real-world studies they plan has been carried out.

Kornstein Lab for Antisemitism Research · November 2026 · Drafted with substantial AI assistance (Anthropic's Claude), directed and reviewed by the lab; full paper and code available on request.